COMPARISON · TWO EMPLOYERS FOR A SENIOR DESIGNER

Netflix vs Spotify

Research dates Nov 6–7, 2026
Independent research. Not affiliated with or endorsed by either company.

Bottom line

Netflix pays far more for senior design and is building new kinds of experiences (live sports, Netflix House, games), but it is in a turbulent year of layoffs and leadership change. Spotify is on a calmer, profitable growth run with a better work/life reputation, but has almost no design roles open and pays mid-market for brand work. The deciding factor is pay and ambition at Netflix versus stability and balance at Spotify.

01 Side by side

	Netflix	Spotify
What they do	Paid streaming of series, films, games and live events, with an ad tier	Music, podcasts and audiobooks on a free tier and paid Premium
Founded · HQ	1997 · Los Gatos, CA	2006 · Stockholm; big teams in London and New York
Size	~16,000 at end-2025; ~1,000 cut in Oct 2026 REPORTED	7,000+ per the 2025 annual report VERIFIED
Money	$51.1B revenue guided for 2026 (+13%), 31.5% operating margin VERIFIED	€17.2B revenue in 2025; Q3 2026 +16% at a 13.5% operating margin VERIFIED
Market value	~$269B (Nov 5), about a third below end-2025 REPORTED	~$124B (Nov 6), about 3% above end-2025 REPORTED
Last 12 months	Lost Warner Bros. to Paramount; layoffs; new content chief; ad forecast cut	Record margins; new co-CEOs; 2030 plan for 1B users
Pay for design	Senior Product Designer, Emerging Creative: $350K–$520K, salary only (posting removed Oct 1, 2026) REPORTED	Designer, Brand and Marketing (mid-level, NYC): $96K–$137K plus equity (removed May 13, 2026) REPORTED
Open roles	~989, aggregator count ESTIMATE	77 on the careers site, 1 in design VERIFIED
Where you'd work	LA, Los Gatos, New York; some design roles remote US	London, Stockholm, New York; hybrid
Employee reviews	Glassdoor 4.1 (2,570 reviews), 80% recommend; work/life 3.5	Glassdoor 4.0 (1,400+ reviews), 77% recommend; work/life 4.3
Culture in a line	High bar and candid: “a pro sports team, not a family”	Collaborative and steady; slower career growth
Brand and creative	Netflix Sans, Tudum, Netflix House, an in-house team for vision videos and promos	Spotify Mix, Wrapped, Spotify Beach at Cannes, public brand guidelines

	Netflix	Spotify
Biggest risk	Losing attention to YouTube; more product and tech cuts	AI disruption and dependence on four music rights holders

The two pay figures are for different levels and teams, so they show what each company has posted, not a like-for-like offer.

02 Scorecard

	Netflix	Spotify	
Stability	●●●●○	●●●●●	Both very profitable; Netflix docked for layoffs and leadership churn.
Momentum	●●●○○	●●●●○	Spotify is growing users and margins; Netflix is resetting after a hard year.
Culture	●●●○○	●●●●○	Similar overall ratings; Spotify scores much higher on work/life.
Hiring and pay	●●●●○	●●○○○	Netflix pays top of market; Spotify has one design opening.
Brand ambition	●●●●●	●●●●●	Both are among the most design-led consumer brands.

03 The case for each

Choose Netflix if...

- Pay matters most: senior design bands run $350K–$520K, and you pick your own salary and stock mix.
- You want to design new formats: live sports, Netflix House, TV games, vision videos.
- You thrive on a high bar, candid feedback and fast decisions.

Choose Spotify if...

- You want steadier footing: record margins and a clear plan to 2030.
- You love music culture and data-driven brand moments like Wrapped.
- Work/life balance matters, and you can work from London, Stockholm or New York.

04 What would settle it

01 Is there a real opening at your level?
Spotify lists one design role right now, and its last brand posting was mid-level.

02 What is the pay band for the exact role and level?
The posted figures above aren't comparable across levels and teams.

03 How did Netflix's October reorganization change the design team?
Most of the ~1,000 cuts were in product and technology.

04 Would you sit in brand and marketing, or in product design?
Both companies keep these in different places, with different partners and pace.

05 What are the office expectations?
Netflix has remote US design roles; Spotify’s openings are hub-based and hybrid.

05 Sources

1. Netflix Q3 2026 shareholder letter · SEC · Oct 20, 2026
2. Netflix to lay off 1,000 staff · TechCrunch · Oct 14, 2026
3. Netflix market cap · CompaniesMarketCap · Nov 5, 2026
4. Senior Product Designer, Emerging Creative · Built In LA · removed Oct 1, 2026
5. Netflix open jobs · Hirebase · accessed Nov 6, 2026
6. Netflix reviews · Glassdoor · accessed Nov 6, 2026
7. Netflix managers’ keeper test · Fortune · Jun 25, 2024
8. Proposed acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery · Wikipedia · accessed Nov 6, 2026
9. YouTube gets twice as much US TV watch time · Tubefilter · Oct 22, 2026
10. Spotify Q3 2026 results · SEC · Oct 22, 2026
11. Spotify Form 20-F, FY2025 · SEC · 2026
12. Spotify market cap · CompaniesMarketCap · Nov 6, 2026
13. Spotify 2026 Investor Day recap · Spotify newsroom · May 21, 2026
14. Spotify jobs · Life at Spotify · Nov 7, 2026
15. Designer, Brand and Marketing (Spotify Advertising) · Built In NYC · removed May 13, 2026
16. Spotify reviews · Glassdoor · accessed Nov 7, 2026
17. Spotify Design & Branding Guidelines · Spotify for Developers · accessed Nov 7, 2026